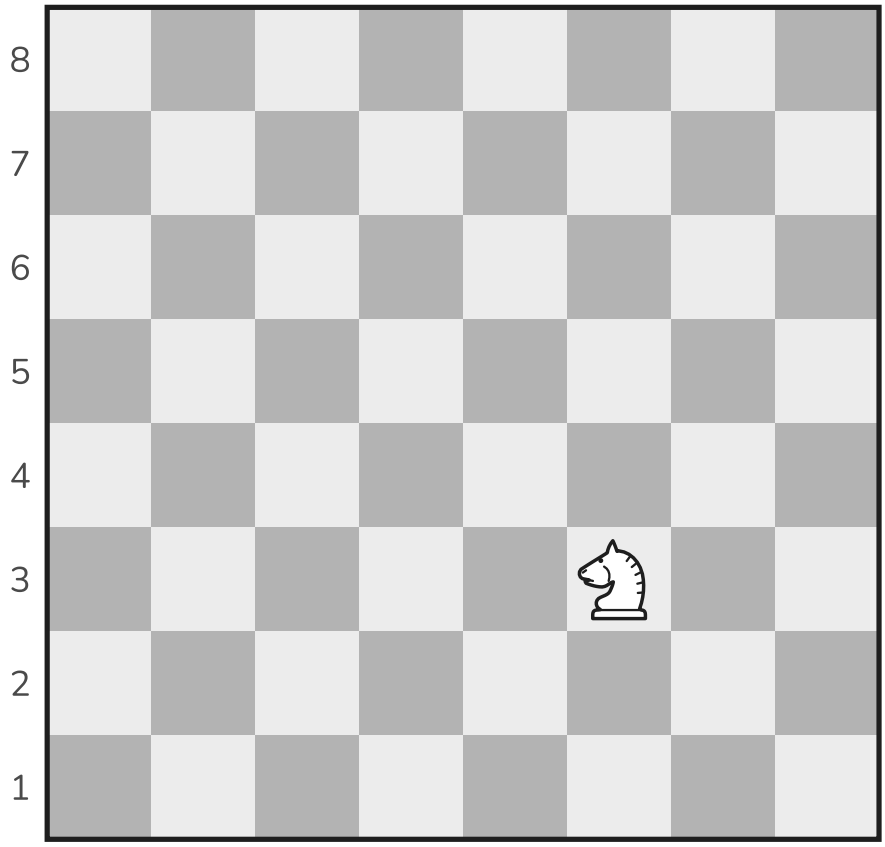
Spot the illegal knight

In his book *My Chess Career* (1920), Capablanca wrote that his father ‘moved a Knight from a white square to another white square’. He was four, and he spotted it.



A white knight on f3

Circle every square this knight can reach. What colour are they all?

ANSWER

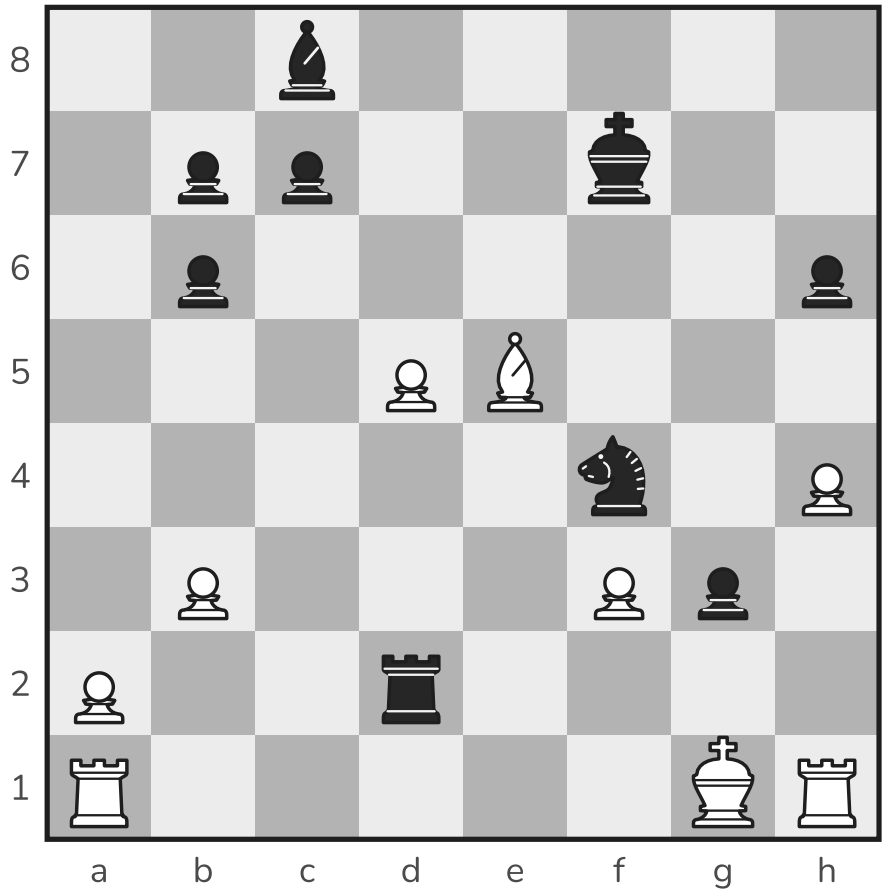
d2, d4, e1, e5, g1, g5, h2, h4. All dark. A knight always lands on the other colour, so a knight that starts and ends on white has broken the rule.

Sources: Capablanca, ‘How I Learned to Play Chess’, *Munsey’s Magazine* (1916); *My Chess Career* (1920); the game score as in *My Chess Career* and chessgames.com. Match facts: Edward Winter, chesshistory.com.

From the RankUp Chess video on how Capablanca learned chess. RankUp Chess is an offline chess app for children; its free first lessons include the knight’s jump. stillwareltd.com/rankupchess

Find his move (he was 13)

Havana, 6 December 1901, game 8 of his match with Juan Corzo, champion of Cuba. Capablanca has Black.



Corzo v Capablanca, Havana 1901, game 8, after 24.Be5: Black to play

Black to play: find the check that starts the end.

ANSWER

24...Rg2+! The king can only go to f1. 25...Rf2+. If 26.Kg1, then 26...Ne2 is checkmate, so Corzo played 26.Ke1, and after 26...Nd3+ he resigned.

The app's own engine rates 24...Rg2+ best by more than three pawns (depth 13 to 15).

Sources: Capablanca, 'How I Learned to Play Chess', *Munsey's Magazine* (1916); *My Chess Career* (1920); the game score as in *My Chess Career* and chessgames.com. Match facts: Edward Winter, chesshistory.com.

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